

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

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**Finding reasoning paths : **

- 1 . Evaluate the duration of symptoms : The sadness , hope lessness , and suicidal ide ations have been ongoing for more than a year .
- 2 . Assess the severity and impact of symptoms : The patient has persistent sadness , hope lessness , and difficulty making decisions , which are indicative of major depressive disorder .
- 3 . Consider the possibility of chronic or recurrent major depressive disorder : The symptoms suggest a significant depressive episode lasting more than a year , which could be consistent with a form of major depressive disorder .
- 4 . Rule out bipolar disorder : The mention of suicidal ide ations and worsening over two weeks is more indicative of un ip olar major depressive disorder than bipolar disorder , which typically includes mood swings .
- 5 . Explore other potential conditions : Conditions like hyp othy roid ism or other medical issues could cause depressive symptoms , but the chronic ity of symptoms and lack of physical triggers make this less likely .

**Reason ing Process : **

- 1 . **Duration of Symptoms : ** The patient has felt sad for as long as he can remember , indicating a chronic condition . The depressive symptoms have persisted for over a year , which is a key factor in distinguishing between un ip olar and bipolar depressive disorders . A diagnosis of un ip olar major depressive disorder would be supported by the long duration of symptoms .
- 2 . **Severity and Impact : ** The patient exhibits persistent sadness , hope lessness , and difficulty making decisions , which are hallmark symptoms of major depressive disorder . These symptoms significantly impair his functioning and relationships , further supporting the diagnosis of a depressive disorder .
- 3 . **Re current vs . Chronic : ** The patient 's symptoms are not described as recurrent episodes but as a continuous state . This align s with the diagnosis of un ip olar major depressive disorder rather than a recurrent depressive disorder , which typically involves multiple episodes within a shorter period .
- 4 . **Ex clusion of Bip olar Disorder : ** The suicidal ide ations and worsening of symptoms over two weeks are more characteristic of un ip olar depression than bipolar disorder . Bip olar disorder often involves mood swings , which are not reported here .
- 5 . **Ex clusion of Medical Causes : ** While medical conditions like hyp othy roid ism can cause depressive symptoms , the chronic nature of the symptoms and the absence of physical triggers like weight changes or fatigue make this less likely .

**Conclusion : **

Based on the duration of symptoms , the severity and impact of the depressive symptoms , and the exclusion of bipolar disorder , the patient is most likely to have a diagnosis consistent with un ip olar major depressive disorder . This condition involves feelings of sadness and hope lessness lasting over a year without clear cyc lical changes , as suggested by the symptoms and reasoning .

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< answer >
The patient is likely to show an hed onia .
</answer >

